Wandsworth Borough Council
Planning Department
The Town Hall
Wandsworth High Street
London
SW18 2PU

Date: 23rd October 2026
Our reference: Ref |1179716

Dear Sir / Madam

The Grange, Bank Lane, London, SW15 5JT | Application for Prior Notification of Proposed Development under Schedule 2, Part 3, Class MA of the Town and Country Planning (General Permitted Development) (England) (Amendment) Order 2024

Knight Frank have been instructed on behalf of Bank of England ('the Applicant') to submit an application for Prior Approval under Class MA, Part 3 of Schedule 2 of the Town and Country Planning (General Permitted Development) (England) (Amendment) Order 2015 (as amended), for the proposed change of use of the existing office accommodation at The Grange, Bank Lane, London, SW15 5JT ('the Site') to provide 48 residential dwellings.

Please find enclosed the following documents which, in addition to this letter, comprises the application for Prior Approval:

- Prior Approval Application Form
- Completed Community Infrastructure Levy Form (prepared by Knight Frank);
- Site Location Plan (prepared by ME Architects);
- Existing and Proposed Floor Plans (prepared by ME Architects);
- Existing and Proposed Elevations (no changes proposed) (prepared by ME Architects);
- Design and Access Statement (prepared by ME Architects);
- Proposed Accommodation Schedule (prepared by ME Architects);
- Acoustic Assessment (prepared by Murray Acoustics);
- Phase 1 Geo-Environmental Desktop Study (Contamination Assessment) (prepared by Manhire Associates);
- Daylight and Sunlight Assessment (prepared by Consil);
- Flood Risk Assessment (prepared by RGP);
- Transport Statement (prepared by RGP); and
- Travel Plan Statement (prepared by RGP);

The requisite application fee of £12,629 (inc. VAT and Planning Portal service charge) has been paid to the Council, under Planning Portal reference number PP-15316493.

Knight Frank, London Planning
55 Baker Street, London, W1U 8AN
+44 20 7629 8171

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Regulated by RICS

The Site

The Site comprises The Grange, Bank Lane, London, SW15 5JT and is located wholly within the administrative boundary of the London Borough of Wandsworth ('LBW'). The Site is located within the Bank of England Sports Ground.

The Site is located in Roehampton to the north of Richmond Park. The Site is bound to the north and west by the Bank of England Sports Ground, to the east by Priory Lane and to the south by Bank Lane. The building itself comprises a 5 storey (5,452sqm) office building (Use Class E(g)(i)) which was constructed as the Bank of England's records office in 1908-09.

Pedestrian and vehicular access to the Site is from Bank Lane to the south.

The Site has a PTAL score of 0, however Barnes Railway Station is situated 1 mile (23-minute walk or 7-minute cycle) to the north, and there are several bus stops within 15-mins walk of the Site.



Figure 1: Site Location and Context.

The Site is not statutorily or locally listed, nor is it located within a Conservation Area. Furthermore, there are no conservation areas or listed buildings in close proximity of the Site.

The Site is located within Flood Zone 1, indicating a Low Risk of flooding.

LB Wandsworth has applied an Article 4 Direction to restrict PDR under Class MA (E to C3) on certain properties in the borough, **Figure 2** below shows an extract from the LBW interactive map of Article 4 Directions which identifies the areas / buildings to which the Article 4 Direction applies, the Site (marked by the blue pin) is not identified as being covered by an Article 4 Direction. Therefore, the Site is eligible for conversion to residential (C3) use subject to meeting the conditions of Class MA Permitted Development.

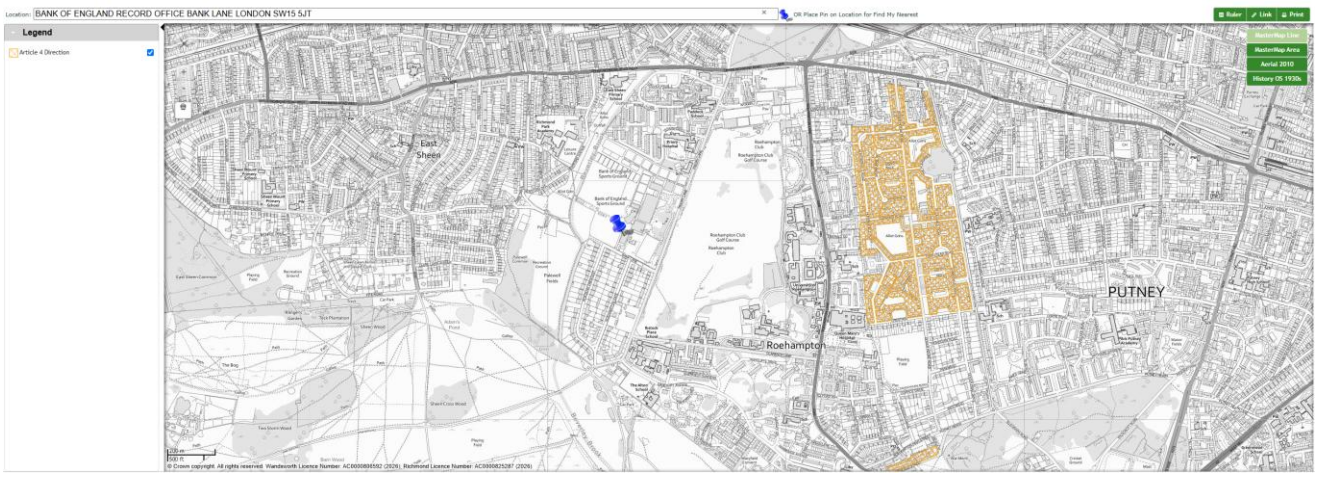


Figure 2: Extract from LB Wandsworth Article 4 Direction map – Site marked by the blue pin.

Site Use and Planning History

The building was constructed as the Bank of England's records office in 1908-09 and as such there are no planning records available coving the original construction of the building.

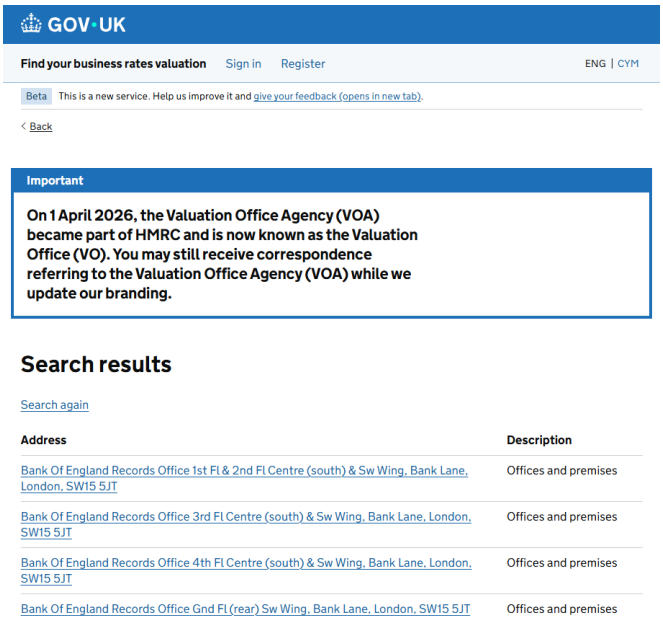
From a review of LB Wandsworth's online planning register, we have identified several planning applications for the Site dating back to 1990s, most applications relate to minor alterations to the building, however of particular interest are the 1997 and 2017 planning consents for the use of the building as office space:

- **2017/2937** | Change of use of ground floor of the south wing from leisure (Class D2) to office (Class B1). | **Approved** 31/07/2017.
- **W/97/0186** | Use as offices (within Class B1). Alterations including erection of new plant room on eastern elevation and installation of air conditioning equipment on roof. | **Approved** 01/05/1997.

The Sites planning history therefore shows that the property has principally operated continuously under commercial, business and service use (Use Class E - formally use class B1) in excess of 29 years since at least May 1997.

Furthermore, the Business Rates Valuations for the Site also shows the property as operating in office use (**Figure 3**), with the available online records detailing is has been so for the last 9 years since at least the 1st April 2017 (**Figure 4**).

From these records it is clear that the Site has been in continuous E Class Use (Commercial, Business and Service) well in excess of two years prior to the date of this prior approval application.


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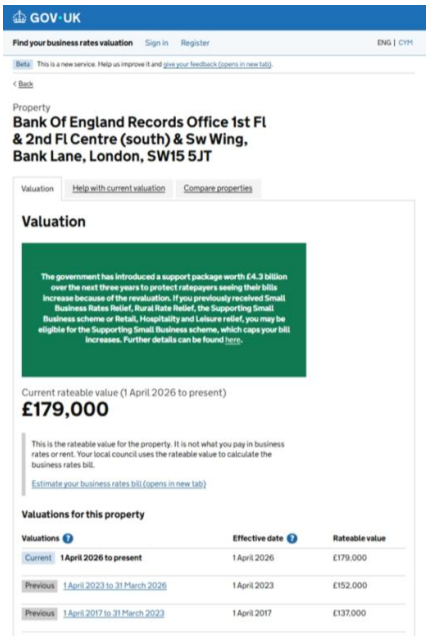
Important

On 1 April 2026, the Valuation Office Agency (VOA) became part of HMRC and is now known as the Valuation Office (VO). You may still receive correspondence referring to the Valuation Office Agency (VOA) while we update our branding.

Search results

Search again

Address	Description
Bank Of England Records Office 1st Fl & 2nd Fl Centre (south) & Sw Wing, Bank Lane, London, SW15 5JT	Offices and premises
Bank Of England Records Office 3rd Fl Centre (south) & Sw Wing, Bank Lane, London, SW15 5JT	Offices and premises
Bank Of England Records Office 4th Fl Centre (south) & Sw Wing, Bank Lane, London, SW15 5JT	Offices and premises
Bank Of England Records Office Gnd Fl (rear) Sw Wing, Bank Lane, London, SW15 5JT	Offices and premises


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Property

Bank Of England Records Office 1st Fl & 2nd Fl Centre (south) & Sw Wing, Bank Lane, London, SW15 5JT

Valuation Help with current valuation Compare properties

Valuation

The government has introduced a support package worth £4.3 billion over the next three years to protect ratepayers seeing their bills increase because of the revaluation. If you previously received Small Business Rates Relief, Rural Rate Relief, the Supporting Small Business scheme or Retail, Hospitality and Leisure relief, you may be eligible for the Supporting Small Business scheme, which caps your bill increases. Further details can be found here.

Current rateable value (1 April 2026 to present)

£179,000

This is the rateable value for the property. It is not what you pay in business rates or rent. Your local council uses the rateable value to calculate the business rates bill.

Estimate your business rates bill (opens in new tab)

Valuations for this property

Valuations	Effective date	Rateable value
Current 1 April 2026 to present	1 April 2026	£179,000
Previous 1 April 2023 to 31 March 2026	1 April 2023	£152,000
Previous 1 April 2017 to 31 March 2023	1 April 2017	£137,000

Figures 3 and 4: Business Rates Valuations Details

Proposed Development

The building comprises 5,457sqm of floorspace across basement, ground, first, second, third and fourth floors. The proposed development seeks to convert 4,929sqm of the buildings floorspace across the ground, first, second, third and fourth floors from office space (Use Class E) into 48 residential units (Use Class C3) with the following unit mix:

- 5 no. Studio Apartments;
- 17 no. One-Bedroom Apartments;
- 19 no. Two-Bedroom Apartments; and
- 7 no. Three-bedroom Apartments.

Permitted Development

The Town and Country Planning (General Permitted Development) (England) (Amendment) Order 2021 (as amended in 2024), Schedule 2, Part 3, Class MA (hereinafter 'Class MA') states:

"*Class MA – commercial, business and service uses to dwellinghouses*

Permitted development

MA. *Development consisting of a change of use of a building and any land within its curtilage from a use falling within Class E (commercial, business and service) of Schedule 2 to the Use Classes Order to a use falling within Class C3 (dwellinghouses) of Schedule 1 to that Order.*

Development not permitted

MA.1 *(1) Development is not permitted by Class MA—*

(b) unless the use of the building fell within one or more of the classes specified in sub-paragraph (2) for a continuous period of at least 2 years prior to the date of the application for prior approval;
(c) part deleted (as amended 2024).
(d) if land covered by, or within the curtilage of, the building—
  (i) is or forms part of a site of special scientific interest;
  (ii) is or forms part of a listed building or land within its curtilage;
  (iii) is or forms part of a scheduled monument or land within its curtilage;
  (iv) is or forms part of a safety hazard area; or
  (v) is or forms part of a military explosives storage area;
(e) if the building is within—
  (i) an area of outstanding natural beauty;
  (ii) an area specified by the Secretary of State for the purposes of section 41(3) of the Wildlife and Countryside Act 1981(1);
  (iii) the Broads;
  (iv) a National Park; or
  (v) a World Heritage Site;
(f) if the site is occupied under an agricultural tenancy, unless the express consent of both the landlord and the tenant has been obtained; or
(g) before 1 August 2022, if—
  (i) the proposed development is of a description falling within Class O of this Part as that Class had effect immediately before 1st August 2021; and
  (ii) the development would not have been permitted under Class O immediately before 1st August 2021 by virtue of the operation of a direction under article 4(1) of this Order which has not since been cancelled in accordance with the provisions of Schedule 3.

(2) The classes mentioned in sub-paragraph (1)(b) are the following classes of the Use Classes Order—

(a) the following classes of the Schedule as it had effect before 1st September 2020—
  (i) Class A1 (shops);
  (ii) Class A2 (financial and professional services);
  (iii) Class A3 (food and drink);
  (iv) Class B1 (business);
  (v) Class D1(a) (non-residential institutions – medical or health services);
  (vi) Class D1(b) (non-residential institutions – crèche, day nursery or day centre);
  (vii) Class D2(e) (assembly and leisure – indoor and outdoor sports), other than use as an indoor swimming pool or skating rink;
(b) on or after 1st September 2020, Class E (commercial, business and service) of Schedule 2.

Conditions

MA.2 *(1) Development under Class MA is permitted subject to the following conditions.*

(2) Before beginning development under Class MA, the developer must apply to the local planning authority for a determination as to whether the prior approval of the authority will be required as to—

(c) transport impacts of the development, particularly to ensure safe site access;
(d) contamination risks in relation to the building;
(e) flooding risks in relation to the building;
(f) impacts of noise from commercial premises on the intended occupiers of the development;
(g) where—
(i) the building is located in a conservation area, and
(ii) the development involves a change of use of the whole or part of the ground floor, the impact of that change of use on the character or sustainability of the conservation area;
(h) the provision of adequate natural light in all habitable rooms of the dwellinghouses;
(i) the impact on intended occupiers of the development of the introduction of residential use in an area the authority considers to be important for general or heavy industry, waste management, storage and distribution, or a mix of such uses; and
(j) where the development involves the loss of services provided by—
(i) a registered nursery, or
(ii) a health centre maintained under section 2 or 3 of the National Health Service Act 2006(2), the impact on the local provision of the type of services lost.
(k) where the development meets the fire risk condition, the fire safety impacts on the intended occupants of the building.

Interpretation of Class MA

***MA.3**. Development meets the fire risk condition referred to in paragraph MA.2(2)(i) if the development relates to a building which will—*
(a) contain two or more dwellinghouses; and
(b) satisfy the height condition in paragraph (3), read with paragraph (7), of article 9A (fire statements) of the Town and Country Planning (Development Management Procedure) (England) Order 2015.

Consequently, in accordance with the provisions of Class MA, the change of use of the existing office accommodation (Class E) at The Grange to provide residential accommodation (Class C3) represents permitted development, as:

- The Site is not covered by an Article 4 Direction;
- The lawful use of the building is as an office falling within Use Class E;
- The Site is not Article 2(3) Land i.e. AONB, SPA, The Broads, National Park, World Heritage Site;
- The Site is not within a Site of Special Scientific Interest (SSSI);
- The Site is not within a safety hazard area;
- The Site is not within a military explosives storage area;
- The building is neither listed, nor located within the curtilage of a listed building; and
- The Site does not contain a scheduled monument.

Paragraph W of the GPDO (2015) (as amended)

In accordance with the requirements of Class MA, the Applicant seeks to notify the London Borough of Wandsworth (acting as the Local Planning Authority) of its intention to proceed with the change of use of the office accommodation (Use Class E) at the ground, first, second, third and fourth floors to provide residential accommodation (Use Class C3) at The Grange, Bank Lane, London, SW15 5JT.

As informed by the Town and Country (Use Classes) Order 1987 (as amended), the Applicant is seeking to change the use of the building from office accommodation (Use Class E) to residential (Use Class C3). The proposed change of use will provide 48 high-quality residential dwellings.

In accordance with Paragraph W of the General Permitted Development Order (2015) (as amended), the following information is provided.

A. Written Description of the Proposed Development

Prior approval for the change of use of ground, first, second, third and fourth floors at The Grange, Bank Lane, London, SW15 5JT from office use (Class E) to residential (Class C3) to create 48 residential units under 'Class MA' of Schedule 2 of the Town and Country Planning (General Permitted Development) Order (GPDO) 2015 (as amended).

B. Plans indicating the site and showing the Proposed Development

Enclosed within this application for Prior Approval is a Site Location Plan, existing and proposed floorplans and elevations of the building to assist the Council in their understanding of the Site and the proposed development. The plans also indicate the total floorspace in square meters of each dwellinghouse, the dimensions and proposed use of each room, and the position and dimensions of windows, doors and walls.

The floorplans also demonstrate sufficient built-in storage and comply with minimum floor to ceiling heights as required by the nationally described space standard.

The proposed floorplans show the layout of the proposed residential apartments. A full accommodation schedule is also provided.

C. Developer's Contact Address

All correspondence should be with the Developer's Agent (contact details are indicated on the accompanying application form).

D. Developer's Email Address

All correspondence should be with the Developer's Agent (contact details are indicated on the accompanying application form).

E. Site-Specific Flood Risk Assessment

Enclosed within this application for Prior Approval is a site-specific Flood Risk Assessment.

Conditions

In accordance with MA.2.(1), the Applicant requests confirmation from the London Borough of Wandsworth as to whether prior approval is required in relation to the proposed change of use at The Grange. The following section considers each of those elements for which prior approval may be required.

Transport and Highways Impacts of the Development

The Applicant has appointed RGP to prepare the Transport Statement that accompanies this application, and that considers the transport and highways impacts of the proposed development.

As noted within the accompanying Transport Statement, although the site has a PTAL rating of 0, it benefits from access to local amenities, bus services, Barnes Railway Station, walking and cycling infrastructure and micromobility facilities. The proposed Sustainable Transport Strategy and Travel Plan Statement would further promote sustainable travel and reduce reliance on private car use.

The proposed development incorporates provision for 63 cycle parking spaces (alongside the retention of the Sites existing external 13 short stay cycle parking spaces) at ground-floor level on the eastern side of the development, adjacent to the bin store. This cycle parking provision meets the requirements set out in the Wandsworth Local Plan and London Plan. The provision of 63no. secure cycle parking spaces will encourage active travel in and around the Site.

Given the Sites low PTAL level, 36 car parking spaces are proposed (which forms the Sites existing car park). The forecast parking demand of approximately 30 vehicles can be accommodated within the proposed provision, while existing arrangements would accommodate deliveries, refuse collection and emergency access.

The change of use is forecast to reduce overall person trips from 454 to 388 two-way trips per day, with lower person-trip generation during the AM and PM peak periods. Overall, the proposals make appropriate use of the existing site infrastructure and provide suitable arrangements for access, parking, servicing and sustainable travel.

A draft Residential Travel Plan has also been submitted as part of this application. The objectives of the Travel Plan are to influence the travel behaviour of future occupiers of the Proposed Development; to generate fewer single-occupancy car trips than would otherwise be the case by encouraging a modal shift in travel; to help improve the health of occupiers; and to ensure sufficient facilities are available to accommodate the journeys that would otherwise be undertaken by the private vehicle.

Refuse storage would be provided at ground floor level with off-street servicing undertaken from the service road along the southern side of the building, as it currently operates without issue, which connects onto Bank Lane. Deliveries such as post or food takeaway deliveries will occur at the front (western side) of the building vis the main site access from Bank Lane.

On the basis of the assessment undertaken, the proposed development would not result in a severe adverse impact on the transport network in terms of capacity or congestion, nor an unacceptable impact on highway safety. The development would provide appropriate mitigation through its access, parking, cycle parking and sustainable transport measures and is therefore considered to accord with the transport and highways policies of the NPPF.

Contamination Risks on the Site

Class MA requires the Local Planning Authority to determine whether, as a result of the proposed development, taking into account any proposed mitigation, the Site will be contaminated land as described in Part 2A of the Environmental Protection Act 1990.

Part 2A of the Environmental Protection Act 1990 Section 78(2) defines contaminated land as land in such a condition that (a) significant harm is being caused or there is a significant possibility of such harm being caused, or (b) significant pollution of control waters is being, or is likely to be caused.

A Phase 1 Geo-Environmental (Contamination) Study has been prepared by Manhire Associates and submitted in support of this application.

The assessment concludes that there is low risk of significant or widespread contamination from on-site uses based on current and historic records and that off-site uses also present a low risk of significant or widespread contamination.

Additionally, the application site, when redeveloped, would not be considered 'contaminated land' as defined by Part2A of the Environmental Protection Act 1990 (i.e. there is not a complete contaminant-pathway-receptor connection) and therefore no intrusive ground investigations need to be carried out. It is considered that the development proposals are wholly acceptable in relation to contamination and that the Site is suitable for a conversion to a residential use.

Flooding Risks on the Site

Class MA states that upon receipt of the application for prior approval, the Local Planning Authority must consult the Environment Agency where the development is:

- In an area within Flood Zone 2 or Flood Zone 3; or
- In an area within Flood Zone 1 which has critical drainage problems, and which has been notified to the Local Planning Authority by the Environment Agency.

A Flood Risk Assessment has been prepared by RGP and has been submitted in support of this application.

The FRA notes the Site lies entirely within Flood Zone 1 - an area with a probability of flooding less than 0.1% (1 in 1000) of occurring each year and the assessment therefore concludes that the proposed development has an acceptable flood risk within the terms and requirements of National Planning Policy Framework.

Furthermore, in accordance with the NPPF, the proposed land use of residential flats is suitable within Flood Zone 1 and the land use of the proposed development is suitable for the sites location under the terms of the Sequential Test as a site of "more vulnerable" use and therefore the proposed conversion to residential is considered appropriate to the location in Flood Risk terms.

Impacts of Noise from Commercial Premises on the intended occupiers of the development

Class MA required impacts of noise from commercial premises on the intended occupiers of the development to be assessed.

A Noise Impact Assessment has been undertaken by Murray Acoustics and submitted in support of this application, to assess the suitability of the Site for the proposed residential change of use, with a focus on noises from surrounding commercial sources on the intended occupiers of the development.

It is noted that the existing windows (with the secondary glazing that is already installed) achieve the internal noise criteria and no new or upgraded glazing is needed.

The assessment concludes that the noise from the surrounding sports uses is intermittent and confined to the daytime and early evening, and with the retained building envelope the internal levels arising from the commercial premises would be well within the adopted criteria.

Noise from commercial premises is therefore not considered to give rise to an adverse impact on the future occupiers of the development. The proposed change of use to residential should therefore be considered acceptable in noise terms under the prior approval criteria.

The impact of the development on a Conservation Area

The Site is not located within or in close proximity to a Conservation Area, therefore this is not an applicable consideration.

The provision of adequate natural light in all habitable rooms of the new dwellinghouses

The Applicant has instructed Consil to assess that adequate natural light is provided to the habitable rooms within the proposed development.

Class MA does not give a specific definition of 'adequate natural light' but it is well understood that the spirit of the legislation was to avoid the creation of windowless homes which was technically possible under the superseded Class O legislation. The proposed scheme has ensured that all habitable rooms within the proposed plans have windows and allow adequate natural light into each home.

The assessment undertaken by Consil has considered the daylight and sunlight amenity that would be received within the proposed residential accommodation following its change of use from offices to residential.

The results show that 94% of the 126 rooms assessed would meet the BS EN 17037 guidance for daylight, and, tested correctly at dwelling level, 67% of the 48 flats would contain at least one room meeting the guidance for sunlight exposure. Where the guidance is not met, this is properly understood in the context of the constraints of converting an existing office building under permitted development rights, where the size, position and orientation of the existing window openings cannot be altered, and no external works are proposed to this scheme.

For daylight, the non-compliant rooms are all large, deep-plan LKDs and bedrooms in which the living or sleeping area nearest the window would receive good levels of daylight, with only the rear of the room (which is designed to be predominantly artificially lit) falling below the target. This is a considered design response to a deep floorplate served by a single, fixed window wall, and is preferable to compartmentalising these rooms into smaller spaces with no outlook.

For sunlight, the results correlate closely with the orientation of the retained building envelope, with the 16 noncompliant flats served, in the great majority of cases, only by north-facing windows that could not, under Class MA, be relocated or enlarged to introduce a more favourable aspect.

Taking these matters together, and having regard to the advisory and non-mandatory status of the BRE guide's numerical targets, the requirement under Policy P3(2)(a) of the NPPF (August 2026) and Policy DMS1 of the Wandsworth Local Plan for occupiers to have adequate access to light rather than to meet a specific numerical standard, and to the specific prior approval test at paragraph MA.2(2)(f) of the GPDO, it is our opinion that the proposed development would provide adequate natural light to future occupiers of the scheme.

The impact on intended occupiers of the development of the introduction of residential use in an area the authority considers to be important for general or heavy industry, waste management, storage and distribution, or a mix of such uses

The area is not recognised as being important for general or heavy industry, waste management, storage or distribution, or any mix of such uses. Therefore, there are no impacts required to be assessed as part of this application.

Where the development involves the loss of services provided by a registered nursery or a health centre

The Site does not contain a registered nursery or a health centre, therefore this is not an applicable consideration.

The fire safety impacts on the intended occupants of the building

In accordance with paragraph 9A (3) of the TCPA (Development Management Procedure) (England) Order 2015 (as amended), a Fire Statement and Gateway One Fire Statement is not required as the development is not over 18m in height nor contains more than 7 stories.

For the purposes of determining the building height, Class MA makes reference to the Town and Country Planning (Development Management Procedure) (England) Order 2015 which itself states that for the purposes of measuring building height *"the height of a building is to be measured from ground level to the top floor surface of the top storey of the building (ignoring any storey which is a roof-top machinery or plant area or consists exclusively of machinery or plant rooms)".*

As such, in accordance with this and the Building Safety Act (2022) the building height to the top floor finished floor level is 15 metres tall. Therefore, the building does not meet the 18-metre threshold for requiring a fire safety statement to be submitted as part of the application.

Nonetheless, fire safety has been carefully considered in the detailed design process, and the proposals have been designed to relevant standards.

Summary

Given the commentary above, and the supplementary information provided in support of this submission, it is considered that sufficient notification has been provided to LB Wandsworth for the change of use of the office accommodation (Use Class E) to provide residential use (Use Class C3). Upon its completion, the proposed development will deliver 48no. high-quality self-contained residential units.

It is assessed that the submission fully complies with the conditions and limitations set out in Class MA, Part 3 of Schedule 2 to the Town and Country Planning (General Permitted Development) (England) Order 2015 (as amended 2024).

We trust that the enclosed application for Prior Approval is in order and look forward to receiving confirmation of the application's validation. Should you have any queries or require any further information please contact myself in the first instance (James.Bylina@knightfrank.com) or Chris Benham (Chris.Benham@knightfrank.com).

Yours Sincerely,



James Bylina
Principal Planner

James.bylina@knightfrank.com
+44 20 3867 0020
+44 7773 080 918